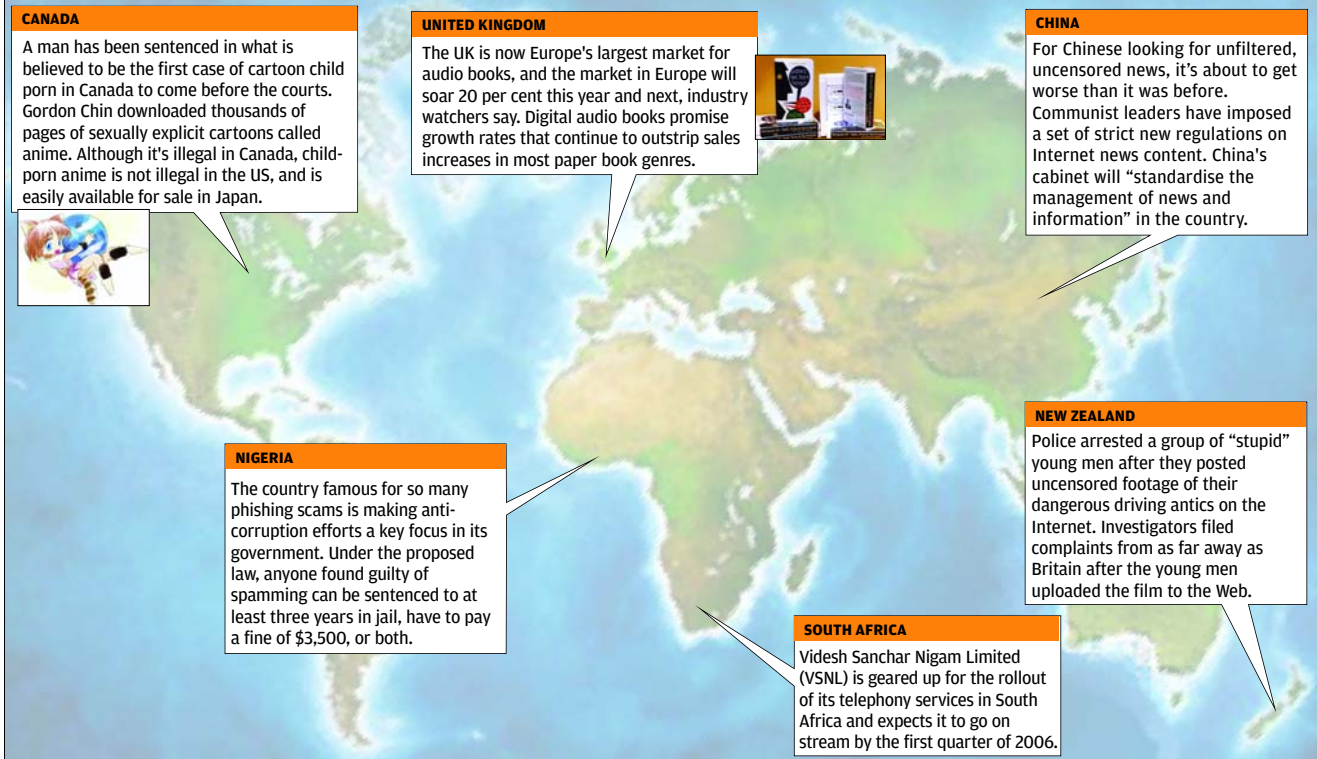


The Digital World

A Round-up Of Technology News From Across The Globe



versions, which are even slimmer and sleeker than the older 20 GB versions. The biggest change is in terms of colour: the new device is a sleek metallic black colour, which will make it stand out in the crowd of older white iPods.

The recent slew of smaller and more portable devices was leading us to believe that Apple wanted to focus on the smaller and cheaper micro, personal audio devices segment, rather than tackle the increasing needs of the portable media player segment. The launch of the new avatar with a 2.5-inch LCD screen has laid those fears to rest.

The company also is expected to feature music videos and TV serials for download via their now-famous iTunes Web site and service—perhaps a renaming of the service might be in order if they start full-blown movie downloads sometime later. Apple has already tied up with Disney and ABC to provide some TV episodes for download at \$1.99 (about Rs 85) an episode.

The new iPod is expected to be priced at \$299 (Rs 13,455) and \$399 (Rs 17,955) for the 30 and 60 GB models respectively, though how much they will cost here in India, even in the grey market, is yet unknown.

All we can say is that the Digit Test Centre is pretty excited, and they're already fighting over who gets to test it when it comes in for review. The iPod's back and prettier than ever!

LIFE'S GETTING BETTER

Google + OpenOffice Vs MS Office?

In early October 2005, Sun Microsystems and Google informed the world of their plans to offer an online version of Sun's OpenOffice.org, presumably as a Google service, to anyone with an Internet connection.

This online version of



Three Incredibly Useful Sites

News And Views

www.automartindia.com



Automart India

Buyers, sellers, dealers and other service providers for new or used cars will find Automartindia.com to be a useful site. Registration is free. You can fill a standard pre-application form for obtaining used car finance and receive responses from multiple finance companies. Also featured are tips on buying, evaluation and insurance.

www.valleyofthegeeks.com



Valley Of The Geeks

This site claims to be 'hi-tech humour served fresh occasionally'. It features news, reviews, and opinions. Subscribing to their newsletter might win you a free copy of *The Valley of the Geeks*! Both the Web site and the book have been recognised for their satirical coverage of Silicon Valley. Give it a look—it's sure to induce a few laughs!

www.thehoot.org



The Hoot

The Hoot is a portal that focuses on everything from media ethics and development in the subcontinent to information, censorship, and the responsibility of the media. The site has specially-segregated information relevant to professionals, teachers, students, readers and viewers of mass media.